

Word family: **blame / blames / blamed / blaming / blameworthy / blameless**

Base word: blame

Part of speech: mainly **verb** and **noun**

Related forms:

* **blame** (v.) — 責怪；歸咎於

* **blame** (n.) — 責任；責備

* **blamed** (adj./participle) — 被責怪的

* **blaming** (n./gerund) — 責怪；歸咎

* **blameworthy** (adj.) — 應受責備的；有過失的

* **blameless** (adj.) — 無過失的；不應受責怪的

* **blamelessly** (adv.) — 無可責備地

* **blamelessness** (n.) — 無過失；清白

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **blame someone**

* **blame someone for something**

* **blame something on someone**

* **be to blame**

* **take the blame**

* **accept the blame**

* **get the blame**

* **put / lay the blame on**

* **shift the blame**

* **share the blame**

* **place the blame**

* **blame yourself**

* **blame culture**

* **blame game**

* **blameless**

* **blameworthy**

Meaning in this passage

> Kevin apologised to me because he had **blamed me unfairly for delaying the project**.

Here, **blamed** means:

said or believed that I was responsible for causing the problem — 怪責；把責任歸到我身上
**

Kevin wrongly believed that the speaker had failed to upload their section and had therefore delayed the whole group.

****中文翻譯：****

Kevin 之所以向我道歉，是因為他曾經****不公平地怪責我拖慢了小組進度****。

So here:

****blame someone for X = 認為某人要為 X 這個壞結果或問題負責****

1. ****blame someone — 責怪某人****

This is the core verb sense.

Practice 1

> Don't ****blame me****.

不要****怪我****。

Practice 2

> She ****blamed Kevin**** for the mistake.

她因那個錯誤而****責怪 Kevin****。

Practice 3

> It's unfair to ****blame one person**** for everything.

把所有事情都****怪在一個人身上****是不公平的。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****blame someone = 認為某人對一件壞事、錯誤或問題負有責任****

2. ****blame someone for something — 因某事責怪某人****

This is the exact structure used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He had **blamed me unfairly for delaying the project**.

他曾經**不公平地怪責我拖慢了項目進度**。

Practice 2

> They **blamed him for the delay**.

他們因延誤而**怪責他**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blame A for B = 認為 A 對 B 這個問題或壞結果負責

3. **blame someone for doing something** — 因某人做了某事而責怪他

Practice 1

> She **blamed him for forgetting the deadline**.

她因他忘記截止日期而**責怪他**。

Practice 2

> I don't **blame you for being upset**.

你感到不開心，我**不怪你**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blame someone for doing X = 認為某人的行為 X 應受到責怪

4. **blame something on someone** — 把某事歸咎於某人

A crucial grammar pattern.

Practice 1

> He **blamed the delay on me**.

他把延誤**歸咎於我**。

Practice 2

> They **blamed the failure on poor communication**.

他們把失敗**歸咎於溝通不良**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blame X on Y = 認為 Y 是造成 X 的原因或應對 X 負責

5. **blame something on a cause — 把問題歸因於某因素**

Practice 1

> He **blamed his reaction on stress**.

他把自己的反應**歸咎於壓力**。

Practice 2

> The delay was **blamed on technical problems**.

延誤被**歸因於技術問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blame X on Y = 把 X 的原因或責任歸到 Y

6. **be to blame — 應負責；是罪魁禍首**

A very common construction.

Practice 1

> I wasn't **to blame**.

我**不應該被怪責 / 不是我的責任**。

Practice 2

> Who is **to blame** for the mistake?

這個錯誤應該由誰**負責**？

MCQ-ready definition:

be to blame = 對某個問題、錯誤或壞結果負有責任

7. **partly / largely / entirely to blame** — 部分 / 主要 / 完全要負責

Practice 1

> Poor communication was **partly to blame**.

溝通不良**要負部分責任**。

Practice 2

> He was not **entirely to blame**.

他並不是**完全應負責**。

MCQ-ready definition:

X is partly/largely/entirely to blame = X 對問題負有不同程度的責任

8. **blame yourself** — 責怪自己；自責

Practice 1

> Don't **blame yourself** for what happened.

不要因發生的事而**自責**。

Practice 2

> She kept **blaming herself** for the mistake.

她一直因那個錯誤而**責怪自己**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blame yourself = 認為自己應對某件壞事負責並因此自責

9. **blame** (noun : 責任) — 責任；過失

A major noun sense.

Practice 1

> He accepted the **blame**.

他接受了**責任**。

Practice 2

> The **blame** does not belong to one person alone.

責任並不只在一個人身上。

MCQ-ready definition:

blame = 對錯誤、問題或壞結果所負的責任

10. **take the blame** — 承擔責任 / 背鍋

Practice 1

> He **took the blame** for the mistake.

他為那個錯誤**承擔了責任**。

Practice 2

> She refused to **take the blame** for something she had not done.

她拒絕為自己沒有做過的事**背黑鍋**。

MCQ-ready definition:

take the blame = 接受自己要為某件壞事負責，無論責任是否完全屬於自己

11. **accept the blame** — 接受責任

Practice 1

> Kevin **accepted the blame** and apologised.

Kevin **接受了責任**並道歉。

Practice 2

> Nobody wanted to **accept the blame**.

沒有人願意**承認責任在自己身上**。

MCQ-ready definition:

accept the blame = 承認自己對問題負有責任

12. **get the blame — 被怪責；背鍋**

Practice 1

> I **got the blame** even though it wasn't my fault.

雖然不是我的錯，我卻**被怪責了**。

Practice 2

> The newest employee always seems to **get the blame**.

那位新員工好像總是**被人怪罪**。

MCQ-ready definition:

get the blame = 被別人認為應為某件壞事負責

13. **put / lay the blame on someone — 把責任推到某人身上**

Practice 1

> He **put the blame on me**.

他把責任**推到我身上**。

Practice 2

> Don't **lay all the blame on one person**.

不要把所有責任都**歸到一個人身上**。

MCQ-ready definition:

put/lay the blame on X = 把問題的責任歸給 X

14. **shift the blame — 推卸責任；轉移責任**

Practice 1

> He tried to **shift the blame** onto someone else.

他試圖把責任**推給別人**。

Practice 2

> Good leaders don't **shift the blame** when things go wrong.

好的領導者在出問題時不會**推卸責任**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****shift the blame = 把原本可能屬於自己的責任轉移到別人身上****

15. **share the blame — 共同承擔責任**

Practice 1

> Both sides **share the blame**.

雙方都要**負部分責任**。

Practice 2

> The whole team had to **share the blame** for the failure.

整個團隊都要為失敗**共同承擔責任**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****share the blame = 多於一方共同對某個問題負責****

16. **place the blame — 歸責；追究責任**

Practice 1

> It is too early to **place the blame**.

現在還太早，不能**追究責任歸屬**。

Practice 2

> The investigation will determine where to **place the blame**.

調查會確定應該把**責任歸到哪裏**。

MCQ-ready definition:

place the blame = 決定或指出誰 / 甚麼應為問題負責

17. **blame** (noun : 責備 ; 指責) — 責備

Practice 1

> She faced a lot of **blame** after the mistake.

犯錯後，她受到很多**責備**。

Practice 2

> The team received unfair **blame**.

團隊受到了不公平的**指責**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blame = 對某人因錯誤或問題而作出的責備

18. **deserve blame** — 應受責備

Practice 1

> He made the decision, so he deserves some **blame**.

決定是他作的，所以他**應負部分責任**。

Practice 2

> Nobody deserved all the **blame**.

沒有人應該承受全部**責備**。

MCQ-ready definition:

deserve blame = 因某人的行為或責任而應受到責備

19. **without blame — 無過失；不應受責**

Practice 1

> She was not entirely **without blame**.

她並非完全**沒有責任**。

Practice 2

> He emerged from the situation largely **without blame**.

在那件事中，他基本上**沒有過失**。

MCQ-ready definition:

without blame = 沒有或幾乎沒有應受責備的責任

20. **blameless — 無過失的；不應受責怪的**

Practice 1

> The speaker was completely **blameless**.

說話者是完全**沒有過失的**。

Practice 2

> She was not entirely **blameless** in the argument.

在那場爭吵中，她也並非完全**沒有責任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blameless = 沒有做錯事，因此不應受到責怪的

21. **blameworthy — 應受責備的；有過失的**

A more formal adjective.

Practice 1

> His behaviour was clearly **blameworthy**.

他的行為明顯**應受責備**。

Practice 2

> The court considered whether the conduct was **blameworthy**.

法院考慮該行為是否屬於**有過失、應受責備**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blameworthy = 因做錯或負有責任而值得受到責備的

22. **blame game — 互相推卸責任；互相指責**

A common figurative expression.

Practice 1

> The meeting turned into a **blame game**.

會議變成了一場**互相推卸責任的指責大會**。

Practice 2

> Instead of solving the problem, everyone started playing the **blame game**.

大家沒有解決問題，反而開始**互相怪責**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blame game = 各方把責任推給別人，而不是集中解決問題的情況

23. **play the blame game — 互相推卸 / 追究責任**

Practice 1

> We don't have time to **play the blame game**.

我們沒時間**互相推卸責任**。

Practice 2

> The team focused on solutions instead of **playing the blame game**.

團隊集中找解決方法，而不是**互相指責**。

MCQ-ready definition:

play the blame game = 不斷爭論誰該負責，而沒有真正處理問題

24. **blame culture — 責難文化；出了事就找人背鍋的文化**

A common organizational expression.

Practice 1

> A **blame culture** makes employees afraid to report mistakes.

責難文化會令員工害怕承認錯誤。

Practice 2

> The company wants to move away from a **blame culture**.

公司希望擺脫**凡事追究個人責任的文化**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blame culture = 組織中一出問題便主要尋找可責怪的人，而非分析原因和改善制度的文化

25. **Don't blame me. — 不要怪我**

Practice 1

> **Don't blame me**—I wasn't even there.

不要怪我，我當時根本不在場。

Practice 2

> **Don't blame me** for the weather!

天氣不好可**別怪我**！

MCQ-ready definition:

****Don't blame me = 表示自己不應被視為問題的責任人****

26. ****I don't blame you. — 我不怪你 / 我能理解你****

A particularly important idiomatic use.

Practice 1

> “I was upset.”

> “I ****don't blame you****.”

「我很不開心。」

「我****不怪你 / 我完全理解你為甚麼會這樣****。」

Practice 2

> I ****don't blame her for leaving****.

她離開，我****完全能理解****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****I don't blame you / someone for X = 我認為你這樣反應很合理，不應因此受責怪****

This often means more than literal “我不責怪你”; it can carry:

****「換了是我也可能會這樣。」****

27. ****you can hardly blame someone — 很難怪某人；某人的反應很合理****

Practice 1

> You can hardly ****blame her for being angry****.

她會生氣也是很合理的，****很難怪她****。

Practice 2

> You can't really ****blame him for feeling nervous****.

他感到緊張也很正常，****不能真的怪他****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****you can hardly blame someone = 某人的反應在情況下很合理，因此不應受到責怪****

Important distinction 1: ****blame vs accuse****

****blame****

say someone is responsible for a bad result.

****accuse****

claim someone did something wrong, often a specific act.

> blame Kevin for the delay

怪 Kevin 造成延誤

> accuse Kevin of lying

指控 Kevin 說謊

Key grammar:

> blame someone ****for**** X

> accuse someone ****of**** X

Important distinction 2: ****blame vs criticise****

****criticise****

point out faults or express disapproval.

****blame****

assign responsibility for a bad result.

You can criticize someone without saying they caused the problem.

Important distinction 3: ****blame vs fault****

****blame****

responsibility/criticism.

****fault****

the actual error, weakness, or responsibility.

> It was my fault.

是我的錯。

> I took the blame.

我承擔了責任。

Related, but not identical.

Important distinction 4: ****blame vs responsibility****

****responsibility****

neutral concept of being accountable.

****blame****

usually negative and tied to something going wrong.

You can have responsibility for a successful project without any blame.

Important distinction 5: ****blame someone for vs blame something on****

Two major grammar patterns:

Person first:

> blame ****Kevin for the delay****

因延誤怪 Kevin

Problem first:

> blame ****the delay on Kevin****

把延誤歸咎於 Kevin

Do not mix them:

> *blame Kevin on the delay* ❌

Important distinction 6: **be to blame vs be blamed**

be to blame

actually be responsible.

> Kevin was to blame.

Kevin 有責任。

be blamed

others say you are responsible.

> I was blamed.

我被怪責。

You can be blamed even when you are **not to blame**.

That distinction is extremely relevant to your passage.

Important distinction 7: **take the blame vs be to blame**

be to blame

you actually caused/are responsible for it.

take the blame

you accept responsibility, which may or may not truly be yours.

Someone can take the blame to protect someone else.

Important distinction 8: ****accept blame vs admit a mistake****

****admit a mistake****

acknowledge you did something wrong.

****accept blame****

accept responsibility for the negative outcome.

Often they occur together, but they are not identical.

Important distinction 9: ****shift the blame vs explain the cause****

****shift the blame****

deflect responsibility onto someone else.

****explain the cause****

neutrally identify what caused the problem.

Saying “stress affected my judgment” is not necessarily shifting blame if you still accept responsibility.

Important distinction 10: ****blame yourself vs take responsibility****

****blame yourself****

can be emotional and self-critical.

****take responsibility****

more constructive and action-focused.

Someone can take responsibility without endlessly blaming themselves.

Important distinction 11: ****blameless vs innocent****

blameless

not deserving blame in a particular matter.

innocent

broader; may mean not guilty of wrongdoing/crime or naïve.

In your passage, **blameless** would mean the speaker was not responsible for the delay.

Important distinction 12: **blameworthy vs guilty**

blameworthy

deserves criticism/responsibility.

guilty

can be moral or specifically legal guilt.

****Blameworthy**** does not automatically mean legally guilty.

Important distinction 13: **blame game vs investigation**

blame game

focuses on who to attack or fault.

investigation

focuses on what actually happened and why.

A healthy team ideally investigates causes rather than playing the blame game.

Important distinction 14: **I don't blame you**

This phrase is often idiomatic approval/understanding:

> I don't blame you for being upset.

means:

**你會不開心很合理，我完全理解。 **

It does **not** simply mean:

> “I am not assigning formal responsibility to you.”

Important distinction 15: **unfair blame vs fair responsibility**

In your passage, Kevin's error was not simply that he criticized the speaker; it was that he:

assigned responsibility without checking the facts

That is exactly what **blame unfairly** captures.

Family-extension note

Blame has one strong semantic core:

assign responsibility for something bad

That develops into:

1. **verb: assign fault**

* blame someone

* blame A for B

* blame B on A

2. **responsibility state**

* be to blame

* partly to blame

3. **noun: responsibility**

* take the blame

* share the blame

4. **deflection**

- * shift the blame
- * blame game

5. **moral evaluation**

- * blameless
- * blameworthy

6. **idiomatic empathy**

- * I don't blame you
- * you can hardly blame her

For your passage, the key branch is:

assigning personal responsibility for the group's delay

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
blame someone	責怪某人	assign responsibility	
blame A for B	因 B 怪 A	person responsible	
blame B on A	把 B 歸咎於 A	cause/responsibility	
blame on stress	歸咎於壓力	causal attribution	
be to blame	應負責	actually responsible	
partly to blame	負部分責任	partial responsibility	
blame yourself	自責	self-blame	
blame (noun)	責任；責備	fault	
take the blame	承擔責任	accept fault	
accept the blame	接受責任	acknowledge fault	
get the blame	被怪責	receive fault	
put/lay blame on	把責任推到.....	assign fault	
shift the blame	推卸責任	redirect fault	
share the blame	共同承擔責任	joint fault	
place the blame	歸責	determine fault	
blameless	無過失的	deserves no blame	
blameworthy	應受責備的	deserves blame	
blame game	互相推卸責任	blame-shifting	
blame culture	責難文化	organizational blame	
Don't blame me	不要怪我	deny responsibility	
I don't blame you	我不怪你 / 我理解你	empathy	
can hardly blame someone	很難怪某人	reaction is understandable	

For your original sentence

> Kevin apologised to me because he had **blamed me unfairly for delaying the project**.

Here:

blamed me unfairly = 在沒有查清楚事實前，就把「拖慢小組進度」的責任歸到我身上

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> Kevin 之所以向我道歉，是因為他曾經**不公平地怪責我拖慢了小組進度**。

The especially useful contrast is:

> **I was blamed**

> = 別人把責任歸給我

> **I was to blame**

> = 我實際上真的有責任

In this passage, the speaker **was blamed**, but was **not to blame**. That distinction is the heart of the misunderstanding.